

ALL INDIA DISCOMs ASSOCIATION (AIDA)
CBIP Building, Malcha Marg, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi - 110021

Minutes of Meeting of Committee on Smart Grid Technologies

Minutes of Meeting of Committee on Smart Grid Technologies held virtually on 23rd October, 2025 at 3.00 PM.

At the outset, Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (Regulatory Affairs) of AIDA welcomed the members of the AIDA Committee on Smart Grid Technologies. The agenda of the meeting is to deliberate on Draft Central Electricity Authority (Cyber Security in Power Sector) Regulations, 2025 issued by CEA on 06.10.2025.

During the meeting, the following inputs/suggestions given by respective Committee Members:

Draft Central Electricity Authority (Cyber Security in Power Sector) Regulations, 2025.

DG, AIDA suggested that Clause 8(1)(e) of chapter 3 may be relaxed for smaller entities, as restricting the CISO role solely to cyber security is practical only for large organizations. Smaller electricity utilities may allow the officer to handle other duties while ensuring adequate focus on cyber security.

Shri Subhadip Ray Chaudhuri (TPCODL) raised a concern that Clause 8(13), Chapter 3, is too broad and open-ended, making it difficult to define scope and costing while framing SLAs with vendors. He suggested that the applicable cyber security requirements and rules be clearly specified at the time of order placement, rather than leaving them open to future changes.

Shri Jitendra Nalwaya, PUVVNL, suggested that Clause 9(6) of chapter 4 contradicts Clause 9(1). While 9(1) allows IT-OT interaction with hardened logical separation based on business needs, 9(6) mandates that the communication channel and data of OT system(s) is isolated from that of IT system(s), which may not be practical since SCADA, OMS, and related systems are interconnected. He recommended aligning 9(6) with 9(1).

Shri Jitendra Nalwaya, PUVVNL, suggested that Clause 12(1) of chapter 5 should clearly define or categorize cyber security incidents, as not all incidents qualify as such. Reporting requirements may be limited to major or significant incidents to ensure clarity and practicality.

Shri Nikhil Pathak, TPDDL, suggested that the minimum experience for CISO in Clause 10, Chapter 5, be reduced from 15 years to 10 years, as 15 years is too high given the limited skilled workforce in this area. DG, AIDA agreed that reducing it to 10 years is appropriate since older professionals may lack updated cyber security expertise.

Shri Jitendra Nalwaya, PUVVNL, suggested that in Clause 18, Chapter 6, the backup policy should ensure more frequent online backups (every 10–15 minutes) for better system recovery, while offline backups may be retained up to a month old.



Shri Subhadip Ray Chaudhuri, TPCODL raised a concern that Clause 33, Chapter 6 on Data Retention Policy should not be limited to cyber security aspects alone, as data retention also covers commercial and legal requirements. He suggested that the policy be broadened to include these aspects.

Shri Praveen Goyal (NPCL) suggested that the regulation should serve as a self-contained guiding document for the power sector, incorporating relevant requirements from National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre (NCIIPC) and other rules and regulations, to avoid overlaps and challenges in complying with multiple regulations.

Shri Jitendra Nalwaya (PUVVNL) raised a concern that Clause 15(2), Chapter 7, requiring completion of all listed scenarios for testing and verification through mock drills, may not be practical or feasible in all cases. He suggested that such exercises be applied selectively based on relevance and feasibility.

Shri Jitendra Nalwaya (PUVVNL) raised a concern on Clause 17, Chapter 8, highlighting that in the case of Distributed Generation Resources (DGR), the responsibility of the vendor for ensuring compliance and cyber protection of prosumers is not clearly defined.

He pointed out that while utilities have better control over vendors in DISCOM-managed installations, individual prosumers may face difficulty in managing vendor-related obligations. Further, vendor responsibilities and aggregation mechanisms for DGR systems are not yet standardized across states. It was suggested that the clause should clearly specify the vendor's role and accountability in such scenarios, particularly for prosumer-level systems.

CGM (IT), APEPDCL raised a concern on Clause 18(3), Chapter 9, suggesting that the timelines prescribed for risk closure after cyber audit are on the higher side. He further recommended that high-risk issues should be closed within two weeks, considering their critical nature, and medium-risk issues within 45 days instead of the proposed three months.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the chair.


31/1/25

Satyendra Nath Kalita)

Convenor, AIDA Committee

List of Participants is annexed below:

Committee Members present

1. Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (Regulatory Affairs), AIDA
2. Shri Jitendra Nalwaya, Director (Tech), PuVVNL
3. Shri Subhadip Raychaudhuri, TPCODL
4. Shri Praveen Kumar Goel, Head, Commercial, NPCL
5. Shri Nikhil Pathak HOD (Automation), TPDDL
6. Shri Anand Singh, GM (Tech), ISGF
7. Shri P. Srinivas, CGM (IT), APEPDCL
8. Shri Rakesh Kumar Prasad, ESE (Revenue) NBPDC

Others present:

1. Shri Alok Kumar, Director General, AIDA
2. Shri Khajan Bhardwaj, Director (Technical), AIDA
3. Shri Sudhir Kumar, Research Officer, AIDA
4. Ms. Garima Morya, Research Officer, AIDA